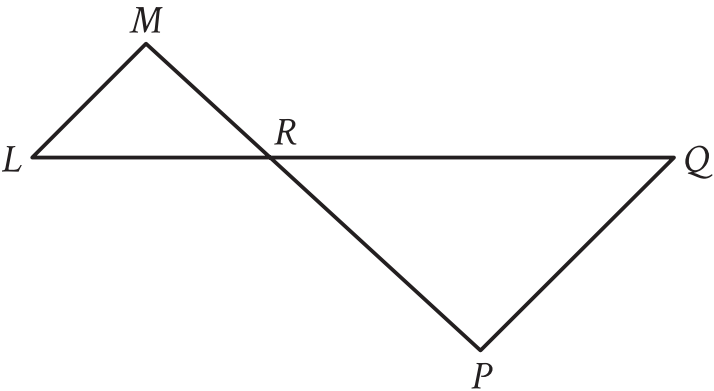


Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Lines, angles, and triangles	Hard

Question



Note: Figure not drawn to scale.

In the figure, $\overline{LQ}$ intersects $\overline{MP}$ at point R , and $\overline{LM}$ is parallel to $\overline{PQ}$. The lengths of $\overline{MR}$, $\overline{LR}$, and $\overline{RP}$ are 6, 7, and 11, respectively. What is the length of $\overline{LQ}$?

Answer

- A. $\frac{119}{11}$
- B. $\frac{77}{6}$
- C. $\frac{113}{6}$
- D. $\frac{119}{6}$

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. The figure shows that angle MRL and angle PRQ are vertical angles. Since vertical angles are congruent, angle MRL and angle PRQ are congruent. It's given that $\overline{LM}$ is parallel to $\overline{PQ}$. The figure also shows that $\overline{LQ}$ intersects $\overline{LM}$ and $\overline{PQ}$. If two parallel segments are intersected by a third segment, alternate interior angles are congruent. Thus, alternate interior angles MLR and PQR are congruent. Since triangles LMR and PQR have two pairs of congruent angles, the triangles are similar. Sides LR and MR in triangle LMR correspond to sides RQ and RP , respectively, in triangle PQR . Since the lengths of corresponding sides in similar triangles are proportional, it follows that $\frac{RQ}{LR} = \frac{RP}{MR}$. It's given that the lengths of $\overline{MR}$, $\overline{LR}$, and $\overline{RP}$ are 6, 7, and 11, respectively. Substituting 6 for MR , 7 for LR and 11 for RP in the equation $\frac{RQ}{LR} = \frac{RP}{MR}$ yields $\frac{RQ}{7} = \frac{11}{6}$. Multiplying each side of this equation by 7 yields $RQ = (\frac{11}{6})(7)$, or $RQ = \frac{77}{6}$. It's given that $\overline{LQ}$ intersects $\overline{MP}$ at point R , so $LQ = LR + RQ$. Substituting 7 for LR and $\frac{77}{6}$ for RQ in this equation yields $LQ = 7 + \frac{77}{6}$, or $LQ = \frac{119}{6}$. Therefore, the length of $\overline{LQ}$ is $\frac{119}{6}$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect. This is the length of $\overline{RQ}$, not $\overline{LQ}$.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.